

Play away the pain

A study conducted by the Jesuit University in West Virginia, sheds some light on the positive effects of the distraction caused by playing video games. Researchers followed two avenues of gaming: active video games and passive, mental video games. The volunteers were monitored for blood pressure, pulse and oxygen saturation. They filled questionnaires that served to ascertain their level of competitiveness and aggressive-



ness. The study found that active video games reduced pain ratings and increased

pain tolerance.

Surprisingly, personality traits prior to the gaming sessions were not a significant factor in affecting pain measures. The North American Society for the Psychology of Sport and Physical Activity will be able to peruse and analyse these findings come June.

.NET is a joke, says Sun

Sun Microsystems CEO Scott McNealy called .NET a joke at a press conference in Singapore. On a tour of Asia, he told the audience that the "world is down to two developer camps: One is .NET, the



other is Sun ONE Java. Java is the number one development platform. Viruses are a feature in .NET, but Java has security built in. I find it funny how the default setting in Win XP lets in Office macros but blocks Java." He added that "Sun ONE runs on every system and processor. Microsoft .NET runs only on Windows. It's mankind versus Microsoft. .NET is a joke." But when asked in Beijing if Sun could eventually triumph, he said "It's difficult for me to defeat Microsoft. Microsoft has a lot of cash in hand."

"Cyberterrorism overhyped", says expert panel

A security panel, comprising security and technology experts, opined that the threat posed by cyber-terrorism has been overhyped. The Net is unlikely to be used as a tool for terrorism, the panel submitted at the CeBit technology fair. "The hype is coming from the U.S Government," said security expert Bruce Schneier.

Fellow panelist and head of security firm RSA, Art Coviello, was of the opinion that some of the warnings on cyber-terrorism were in reaction to the September 11 attacks. He added that section of the media were responsible for amplifying this concern into a threat scenario. "Some of these stories are very entertaining and sell

a lot of newspapers," he said.

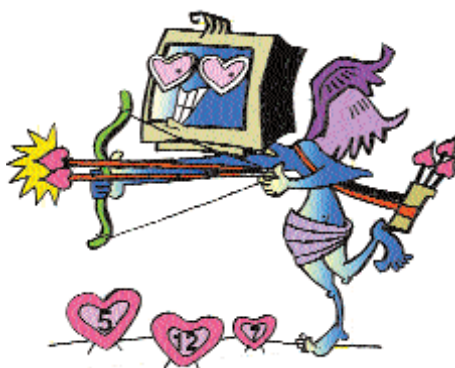
A terror group that wished to extract panic from the populace was unlikely to turn to the Net, Mr Schneier added. Panel members pointed out that companies face more serious threats from ordinary criminals, fraudsters and pranksters than they did from technology-literate terrorists.

A match made in math

A team of MIT neuroscientists have launched a Web site called EasyMixing.com to test whether a person's facial features trigger insights into his or her persona.

Visitors to the site are asked to rate pictures of members based on a mini-questionnaire, and are asked to guess various personal activities, such as the person's favourite past time. The results are stored in a database.

Researches hope to develop a statistical tool from this



exercise that will let match-making Web sites offer a trimmed down list to a visitor,

based on personal preferences. "Instead of wading through several hundred images, you get short list of top 20 or 50 compatible profiles," said Pawan Sinha, an assistant professor of computational and neuroscience at MIT.

MIT is developing this tool from the view of a future entrepreneurship concept.

snapshot

Using the Internet2 network, **6.7** gigabytes of data; the equivalent of four hours of a DVD quality movie was sent in less than a **minute** over a distance of **6,800** miles

Source: Stanford Linear Accelerator Center

■ Gateway cuts jobs, shuts stores ■ Sony to shift PlayStation 2 console production to China ■ Yahoo! to launch a paid video subscriber service